Don't Worry You'll Catch Up

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📋 Executive Summary

Early years of a success journey feel like wasted time, but the slow, directionless grind is normal. Once momentum builds, growth becomes explosive and you recover all perceived lost ground on the back end.

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🌅 The Early Days Feel Directionless — and That's Normal 0:00

- The speaker opens by reassuring people not to stress about the early, slow phase of their success journey
  - In the early days you wake up with no clear agenda — "What should I do? What should I work on?" — and nothing is obvious
  - The work feels random: "spitballing," throwing things at the wall to see what sticks
- He contrasts this with where he is now
  - Today he wakes up knowing exactly what he needs to do and is "a little bit too busy"
  - He says this clarity only came after years of unclear, directionless effort
- The takeaway: feeling lost and unproductive in the early phase is not a sign of failure — it is simply what the beginning looks like

📈 The 10-Year Success Arc: Slow Then Explosive 0:23

- He uses a simple **10-year framework** to illustrate how success timelines actually work
  - Years 1–7: potentially zero visible progression, very slow movement
  - Years 8–10: meteoric, compounding growth — "the aggregation of marginal gains"
- Concrete personal example he gives:
  - Started his success journey at **21, post-university**
  - At **28** he felt unsuccessful and stagnant: "I'm 28 years old. I'm not successful. It's not going well."
  - By **31**, things had shifted dramatically: "Wow, look how quickly things have changed."
- The key insight: you make **more progress in those final 3 years than in the full prior 7**

- The slow years are not wasted — they are the invisible foundation that makes the acceleration possible

⏪ You Make Up "Lost" Time on the Back End 0:49

- The "wasted" early years are actually a front-loaded investment in mistakes and learning
  - You make all the mistakes early
  - Nothing sticks, nothing works, and doubt creeps in: "Is this ever going to work? Have I just wasted five, six, seven years of my life?"
- But once it clicks, the back end compensates fully

> "The time that you quote unquote wasted in the early days, you make up for on the back end."

- His own numbers as proof:
  - Until around **age 27** he was "kind of broke"
  - At **34**, he makes **more in a single day** than he used to make in an entire year at his 9-to-5 jobs at ages 25–27
- The feeling of "going nowhere" and "treading water" is described as completely normal — not a warning sign

🚗 The Speed Analogy: Country Lanes to the Autobahn 1:21

- He uses a driving metaphor to make the concept concrete:
  - Early phase = driving slowly through a busy residential estate and country lanes — low speed, lots of stops, no momentum
  - Later phase = reaching the autobahn and hitting **200 mph**
  - At 200 mph you recover all the time you lost crawling through the estate
- A second analogy: airline delays
  - Pilots announce a late departure, then say "we'll put our foot down, go a little bit quicker, and we will arrive on time"
  - You still land at the same time — you just go faster later to compensate
- Final image: **a loading bar** that creeps along slowly at first, then suddenly races to 100%
  - "That's life. That's success. Don't worry about it. You catch up."
- Closing message: the speed you gain later more than makes up for the slowness at the start — trust the process and stay on the journey